Master Public Speaking

Applied Sciences Communication Course

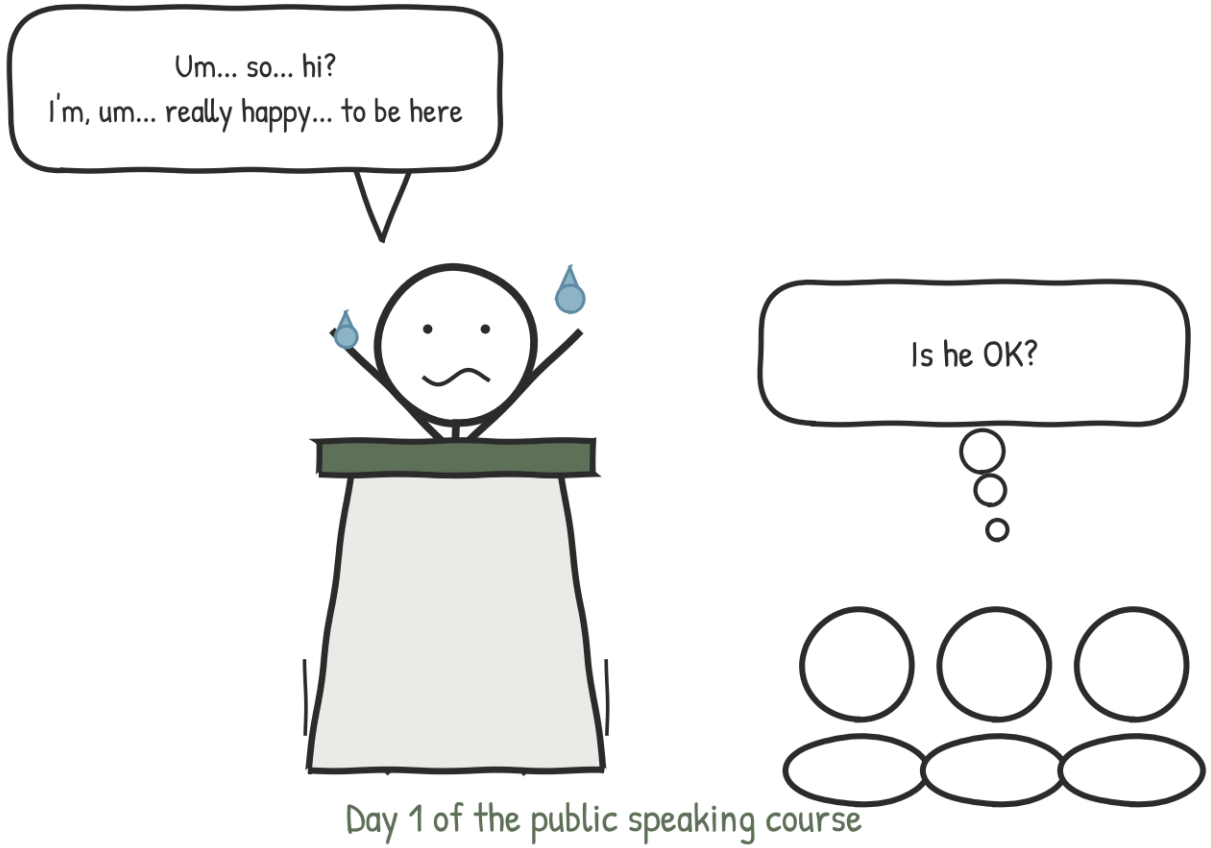
Delivering a successful presentation

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Why are we here? Because almost everyone gets nervous



Glossophobia

the fear of public speaking - is one of the most widely reported social fears among students and professionals alike.

The good news

Speaking is a skill, not a talent. Like any skill, it improves with method, feedback and practice.

Quick poll

Raise your hand if your heart beats faster just reading this slide. (You are in good company.)

Agenda

Presentations are more than just slides; they are about engaging your audience, delivering a message clearly, and leaving a lasting impression. This course covers the essential elements of a great presentation, from rhetorical strategies to visual design and delivery techniques.

1. **The power of communication**
2. **Rhetoric and famous speeches**
3. **Content and storytelling**
4. **Overcoming nervousness**
5. **Body language and voice**
6. **Empathic communication**
7. **Engaging the audience and Q&A**
8. **Visual design**
9. **Communication in applied sciences**
10. **Communication in today's workplace**

Plus: practice workshop, video library and a bibliography for further study

MODULE 01

The power of communication

Key principles of communication in public conversations



Purpose and intent: decide why you are speaking



Inform

Explain, teach, report.

Example: *Academic talks, lectures, technical briefings*



Persuade

Change a belief or trigger an action.

Example: *Political debates, pitches, grant proposals*



Connect

Build trust, belonging and emotion.

Example: *Toasts, commencement speeches, team kick-offs*

Try this before every talk: complete the sentence “When I finish, my audience will know / believe / do …”. If you cannot finish it in one line, your purpose is not clear yet.

Ten key principles for public conversations (1/2)

	PRINCIPLE	WHAT TO DO	EXAMPLE
1	**Clarity of message**	Speak clearly; avoid jargon and over-complex explanations.	*Instead of 'utilize', say 'use'.*
2	**Active listening**	Maintain eye contact, nod and paraphrase what others say.	*'So, you mean that…?'*
3	**Purpose and intent**	Define whether your goal is to inform, persuade or connect.	*Debates persuade; academic talks inform.*
4	**Adaptation to the audience**	Adjust tone and examples to who is in the room.	*Use analogies with non-experts.*
5	**Nonverbal consistency**	Align body language with your words.	*Smile genuinely when expressing gratitude.*

Ten key principles for public conversations (2/2)

	PRINCIPLE	WHAT TO DO	EXAMPLE
6	**Feedback and interaction**	Encourage audience input.	*'How many of you have experienced this?'*
7	**Ethos, pathos, logos balance**	Combine credibility, emotion and logic.	*Martin Luther King Jr.'s speeches blend all three.*
8	**Respect and turn-taking**	Avoid interruptions and listen actively.	*In a panel, let others complete their point.*
9	**Context awareness**	Adapt to cultural and situational norms.	*Humour that works in one culture may offend in another.*
10	**Strategic framing**	Use storytelling or metaphors.	*Frame climate change as a shared responsibility, not a distant threat.*

Myth-buster: is communication really 93% nonverbal?

7% words

38% tone of voice

55% facial expression

The famous 'Mehrabian rule'

Where it comes from

Albert Mehrabian's 1967 lab studies used single spoken words expressing like or dislike, where words and tone contradicted each other.

What it does NOT say

It does not apply to lectures, presentations or most everyday talk. Mehrabian himself warned against generalising it.

The useful lesson

When verbal and nonverbal signals conflict, listeners tend to believe the nonverbal ones. Content still matters - consistency is what convinces.

Know your stuff!

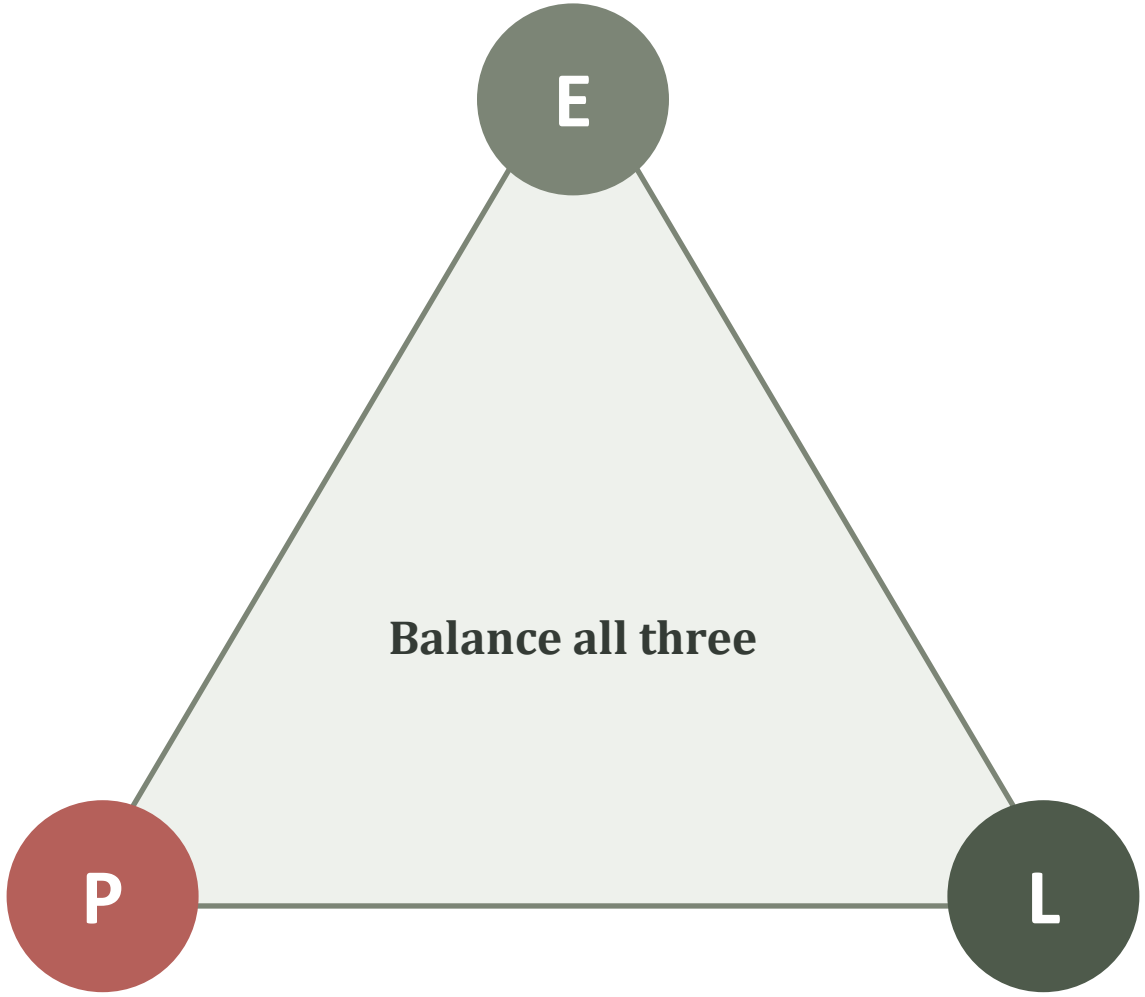
MODULE 02

Rhetoric and famous speeches

Rhetoric: the art of persuasion - from Aristotle to the TED stage



Rhetoric: the art of persuasion



Ethos — credibility

Show your expertise: cite credible sources, demonstrate knowledge, use a professional tone.

Pathos — emotion

Appeal to emotions with stories, real-world examples and visuals that resonate with the audience.

Logos — logic

Use logical arguments and well-structured data. Avoid overwhelming people with too many facts.

Example: *Martin Luther King Jr.'s speeches blend all three - moral authority, vivid emotional imagery and arguments rooted in the Constitution.*

Rhetorical devices in famous speeches

Device	Speech	In the speaker's words
Anaphora (repetition at the start)	Martin Luther King Jr., Washington, 1963	*"I have a dream…" — repeated to build rhythm and hope*
Chiasmus / antithesis	John F. Kennedy, inaugural address, 1961	*"Ask not what your country can do for you…"*
Tricolon (rule of three)	Abraham Lincoln, Gettysburg, 1863	*"of the people, by the people, for the people"*
Repetition + concrete images	Winston Churchill, House of Commons, 1940	*"We shall fight on the beaches…"*
Signposting	Steve Jobs, Stanford commencement, 2005	*"Today I want to tell you three stories from my life."*
Concrete, simple nouns	Malala Yousafzai, UN Youth Assembly, 2013	*"One child, one teacher, one book and one pen can change the world."*

Classroom task: find one device in a speech from your own field - a keynote, a product launch, a thesis defence - and explain why it works.

Speech anatomy: Steve Jobs at Stanford (2005)

Opening	Story 1	Story 2	Story 3	Close
Humble hook + signpost: ‘three stories’	Connecting the dots	Love and loss	Death	Callback: ‘Stay hungry. Stay foolish.’

Why it works

- Clear structure announced in the first minute - the audience knows the map
- Personal stories carry universal lessons (pathos + ethos)
- Short sentences and everyday vocabulary
- The ending echoes a source he loved, giving a memorable final line

Watch and analyse

About 15 minutes. Note every signpost and every pause.

▷ Stanford, 2005 (YouTube)

Two speeches, two lessons for the podium

Martin Luther King Jr., 1963

Prepared, yet flexible

Accounts of the March on Washington describe King moving away from his prepared text after singer Mahalia Jackson urged him to tell the crowd about ‘the dream’.

Lesson: prepare thoroughly so that you can read the room and adapt in the moment.

▷ Text and audio (American Rhetoric)

Malala Yousafzai, UN, 2013

Authentic and concrete

On her 16th birthday, in her first major public speech after being attacked, she used plain words and closed with four concrete nouns: child, teacher, book, pen.

Lesson: authenticity and simple, concrete language move audiences more than ornate style.

▷ Find the speech (YouTube)

MODULE 03

Content and storytelling

Content: clear, concise and purposeful



Content: clear, concise and purposeful

Structure

Use a clear introduction, body and conclusion. Make sure each slide has a clear purpose.

Key messages

One key message per slide. Use bullet points sparingly and avoid too much text.

Storytelling

Weave a narrative throughout the presentation to keep the audience engaged.

Visuals

Support content with relevant images, graphs and infographics that make complex ideas easier to grasp.

Clarity test: ‘In order to utilize the resources at this point in time…’ becomes ‘To use the resources now…’ - same meaning, half the words.

Open strong, close stronger

Five ways to open

- A question: ‘Who here has ever sat through a 60-slide talk?’
- A surprising fact or number
- A short personal story (30–60 seconds)
- A striking image, object or demonstration
- A bold statement you will prove

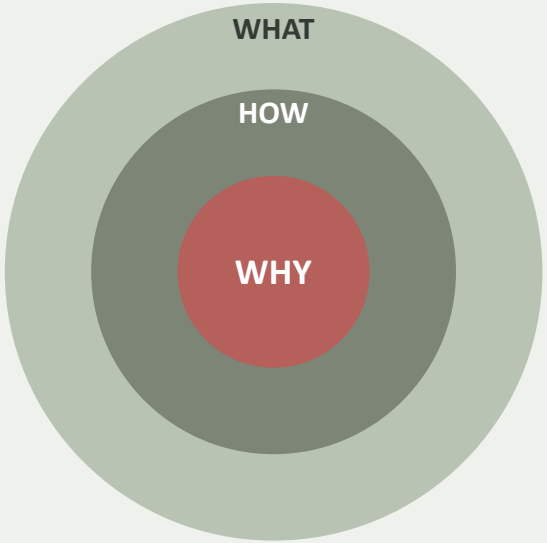
Avoid: apologising, ‘I’m not an expert, but…’, reading the agenda aloud.

Four ways to close

- A call to action: what should people do tomorrow?
- A callback to your opening story or question
- Your three key points, in one breath
- One memorable sentence - then stop

Avoid: ‘So… um… that’s it, I guess.’ Your last words are the ones people remember.

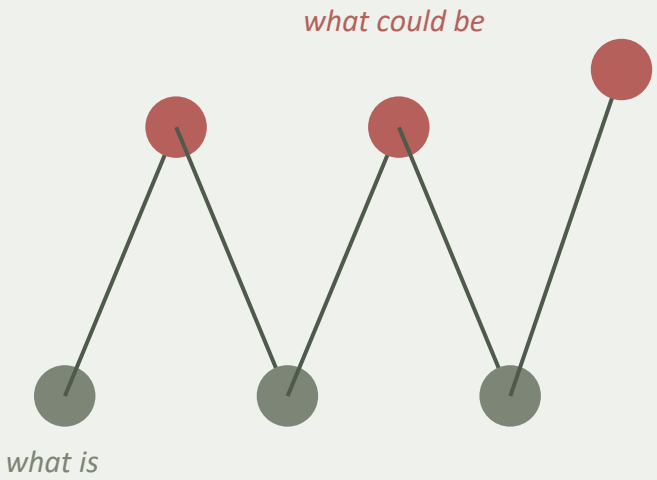
Storytelling frameworks you can borrow



The Golden Circle

Simon Sinek: start with why it matters, then how, then what.

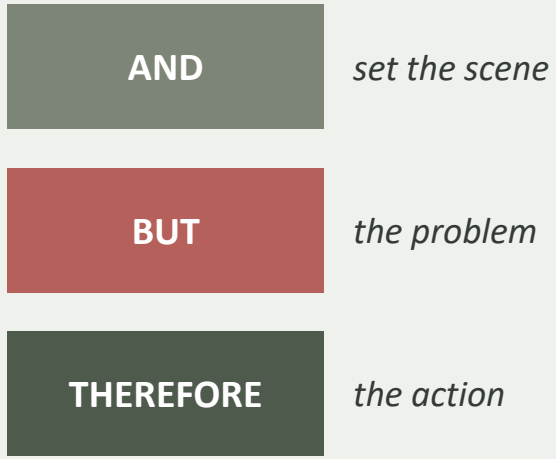
▷ Sinek, TED 2009



The ‘sparkline’

Nancy Duarte: alternate ‘what is’ and ‘what could be’, end with the new bliss.

▷ Duarte, TEDx 2011

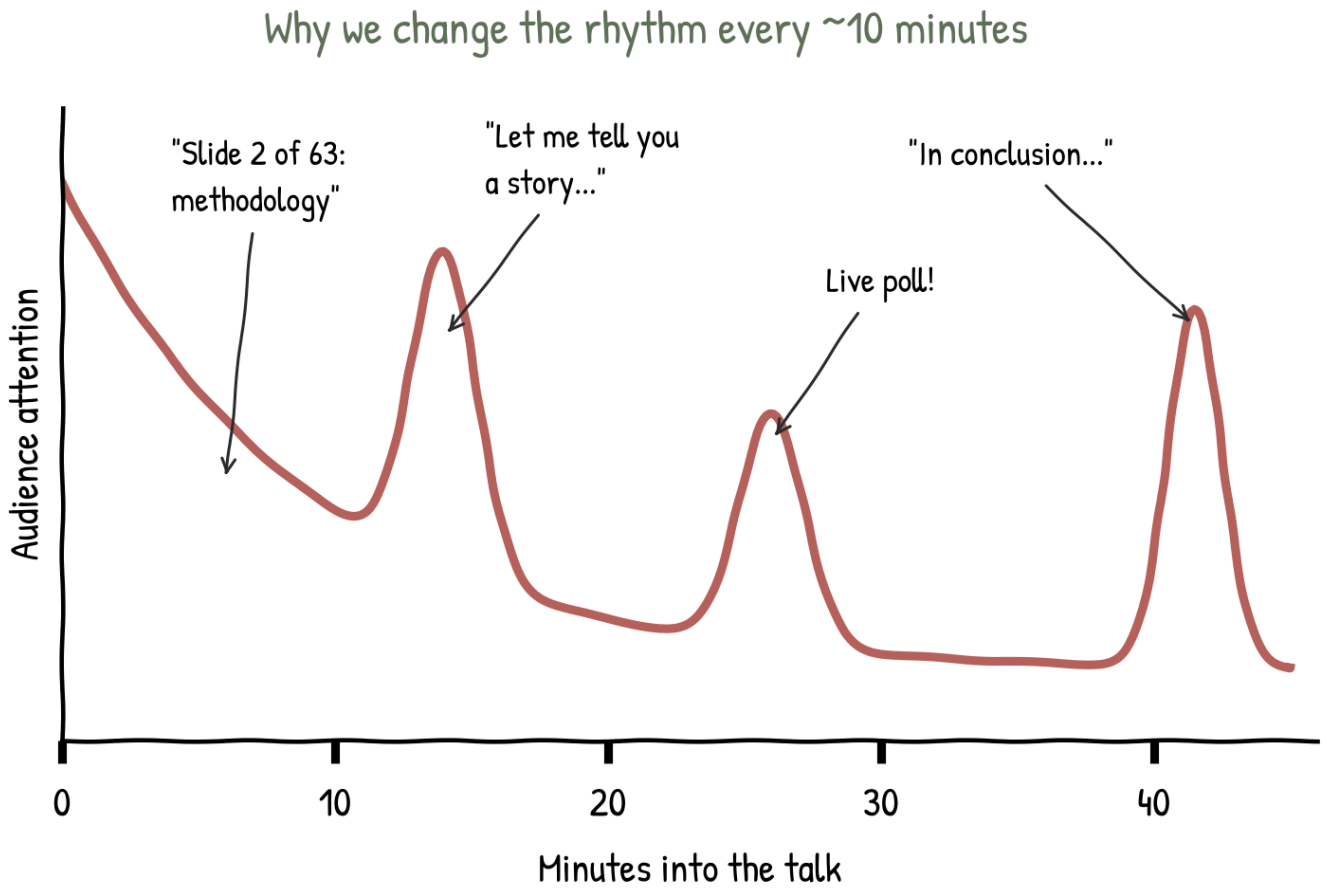


ABT template

Randy Olson’s narrative core - ideal for scientists, pitches and abstracts.

We tested X AND Y, BUT Z failed, THEREFORE we…

Attention is a resource: spend it wisely



- Change the rhythm every few minutes: a story, a question, a demo, a short video
- Use concrete examples before abstract principles
- Frame your message strategically: ‘shared responsibility’ moves people more than ‘distant threat’
- Signal structure: ‘First… Now the surprising part… Finally…’
- People perk up at ‘In conclusion’ - so make the conclusion worth it

MODULE 04

Overcoming nervousness

Confidence-building strategies



Confidence-building strategies that research supports

Reframe the arousal

Say ‘I am excited’ rather than ‘I am calm’. Reappraising anxiety as excitement improved speech performance in experiments (Brooks, 2014).

Breathe out slowly

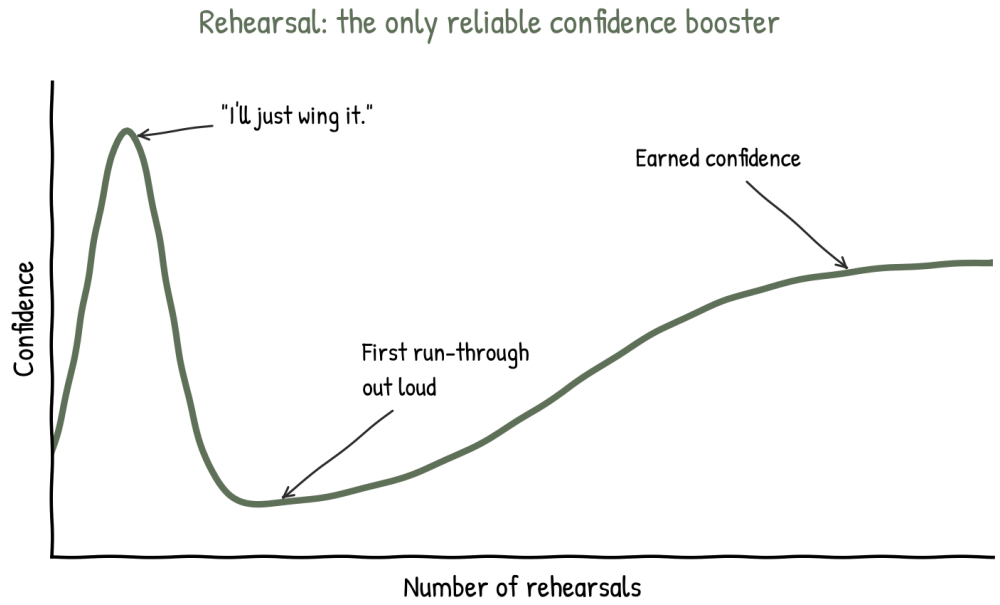
Long exhalations, such as the ‘cyclic sigh’, reduced physiological arousal in a 2023 study (Balban et al.).

Rehearse out loud

On your feet, timed, with the clicker. Know your first 60 seconds by heart.

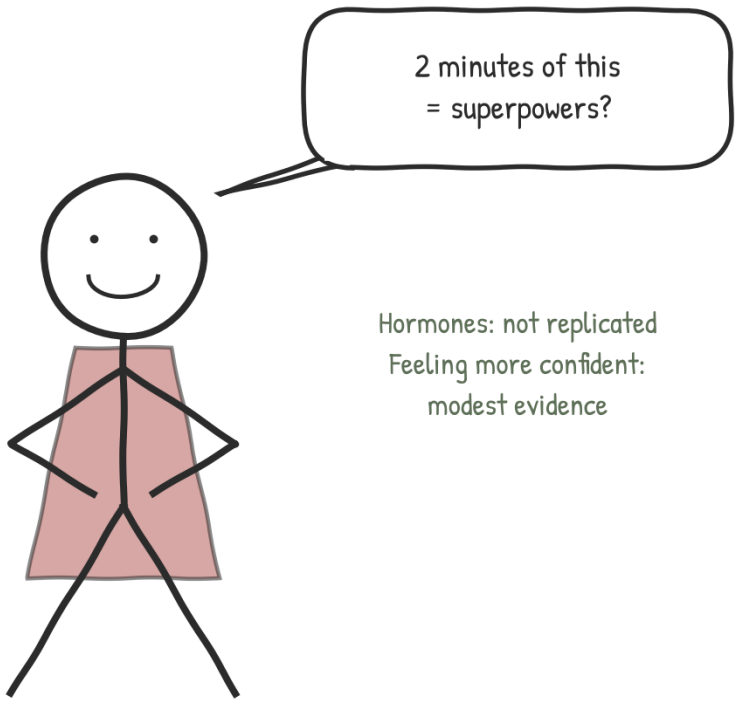
Shift the spotlight

Focus on what the audience needs, not on how you look. Arrive early and test the equipment.



Humorous illustration, not data (but based on data & experience)

Power posing: a lesson in reading research critically



Power posing: read the research critically

▷ Amy Cuddy, TED 2012

2010 Carney, Cuddy and Yap report that expansive poses change hormones and risk-taking.

2012 Amy Cuddy's TED talk becomes one of the most-watched ever.

2015 A larger replication finds no hormonal effect (Ranehill et al.).

2018 A review finds evidence that posture can influence how powerful people feel.

Takeaway: an upright, open posture may help you feel more confident - but no pose replaces preparation.

MODULE 05

Body language and voice

Posture, gestures, eye contact — and the instrument you always carry: your voice



Posture and body language



Eye contact

Engage your audience by making eye contact to build trust and connection.



Gestures

Use purposeful hand gestures to emphasise points. Avoid excessive movement that may distract.



Posture

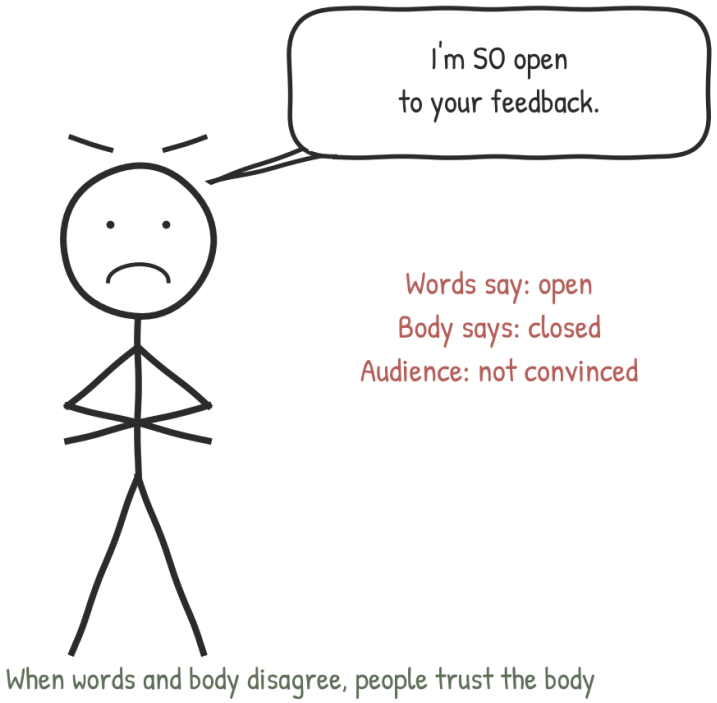
Stand tall, feet shoulder-width apart, projecting confidence.



Movement

Move around the stage naturally, but avoid pacing or fidgeting.

Nonverbal consistency: align your body with your words



Do

- Smile genuinely when expressing gratitude
- Open palms when inviting ideas
- Lean slightly forward when listening
- Nod to show you are following
- Pause and face the audience before a key point

Avoid

- Crossed arms while saying ‘I’m open’
- Hands in pockets or clasped ‘fig-leaf’ style
- Clicking pens, playing with rings
- Talking to the screen instead of people
- A smile that never reaches the eyes

Eye contact and gestures that work in 2026

One thought, one person

Hold eye contact for a full sentence (about 3–5 seconds), then move to someone else in another part of the room.

Online: look at the lens

Place the camera at eye level and your notes just below it; to the audience, the lens is their eyes.

Gesture inside the box

Keep most gestures between shoulders and waist; make them bigger in larger rooms.

Control your expressions

Let your face match your content: serious data, serious face; good news, real smile.

Gesture the meaning

Show numbers with fingers, contrasts with two hands, time from left to right.

Stillness is strong

Plant your feet when you deliver the key message. Move during transitions.

Context awareness: body language across cultures

Thumbs-up	Positive in much of Europe and the Americas; considered rude in parts of the Middle East and West Africa.
The ‘OK’ ring gesture	Approval in the US; can be an insult in countries such as Brazil or Turkey.
Direct eye contact	Signals honesty in many Western contexts; prolonged contact with seniors can feel disrespectful in parts of East Asia.
Nodding	In Bulgaria, a traditional nod can mean ‘no’ and a head shake ‘yes’.
Humour	Irony and self-deprecation travel badly; humour that works in one culture may offend in another.



Rule of thumb

Before speaking abroad or to an international audience, ask a local colleague: ‘Is there anything I should not do on stage here?’ Norms vary within countries and generations too.

Effective delivery techniques



Your voice

A powerful tool in public speaking: varying pitch, tone and volume conveys emotion, emphasises points and maintains interest.

- Pitch variation
- Tone inflection
- Volume control



Your body

Effective body language enhances your message, making it more impactful and memorable.

- Meaningful eye contact
- Purposeful gestures
- Good posture
- Controlled expressions

Voice and delivery

Tone

Vary your tone to keep the audience interested. Avoid monotone speech.

Pacing

Speak slowly and clearly. Allow pauses for emphasis and to give the audience time to absorb information.

Volume

Adjust to the room and audience size: loud enough to be heard, but not overwhelming.

Enthusiasm

Show passion for your topic; enthusiasm is contagious and keeps the audience engaged.

Julian Treasure's vocal toolbox

Register · Timbre · Prosody · Pace · Pitch · Volume

His foundation for being listened to is HAIL:

Honesty, Authenticity, Integrity, Love

Exercise: read the same sentence three times — as good news, as bad news, as a secret.

▷ Treasure, TED 2013

The power of the pause (and the problem with ‘um’)

1–3 s

a pause that feels endless to you feels natural - even powerful - to the audience

about 130–160

words per minute: a comfortable presenting pace for most audiences

Pause…

- before your key message, so people lean in
- after a question, so people can actually think
- between sections, as a spoken paragraph break
- instead of ‘um’, ‘so’, ‘like’, ‘basically’

Famous example

In his 2015 eulogy in Charleston, Barack Obama paused in long silence before beginning to sing ‘Amazing Grace’ - and the hall sang with him. Silence can be the most eloquent part of a speech.

MODULE 06

Empathic communication

Listening, understanding and speaking so that people feel heard



What is empathic communication?



Cognitive empathy

‘I understand how you see it.’

Anticipate what your audience knows, doubts and needs.



Emotional empathy

‘I feel it with you.’

Acknowledge the emotions in the room — stress, excitement, fatigue.



Empathic concern

‘I want to help.’

Turn understanding into useful action: your talk should serve them.

Why it matters now: ‘empathy and active listening’ appears among the top ten core skills employers name in the World Economic Forum’s Future of Jobs Report 2025.

Active listening and respectful turn-taking

Paraphrase

‘So, you mean that…?’

Clarify

‘Could you give me an example?’

Reflect feelings

‘It sounds like this deadline worries you.’

Summarise

‘Let me check I’ve got the three points right…’

Let others finish

In a panel, allow others to complete their point.

Signal, don’t seize

A raised hand or ‘May I add something?’ beats interrupting.



‘Seek first to understand, then to be understood.’

Stephen R. Covey, *The 7 Habits of Highly Effective People*

Nonviolent Communication in four steps

O — Observation

Facts, without judgement

“The slides arrived one hour before the meeting.”

F — Feeling

Name your emotion

“I felt stressed…”

N — Need

Say what matters to you

“…because I need time to rehearse.”

R — Request

Concrete, doable, negotiable

“Could we agree on a 24-hour deadline?”

Instead of…

“You never send the slides on time!”

Try…

the four steps above, read as one sentence. Same problem, no blame - and a far better chance of a ‘yes’.

Know your audience: an empathy map for speakers

KNOW

What do they already know? Which terms need explaining?

FEEL

What are they worried or excited about today?

NEED

What problem must your talk solve for them?

RESIST

What objections or doubts will they bring?

→ DO

What should they think, feel and do when you finish?

- Engineers: data, method, limitations
- Managers: impact, cost, decision
- General public: analogies and stories
- Mixed room: layer the message - headline first, detail on demand

Adaptation to the audience: adjust tone and examples - use analogies when speaking to non-experts.

MODULE 07

Engaging the audience and Q&A

From passive listeners to active participants



Engaging the audience



Eye contact

Make eye contact to create a sense of intimacy and involvement.



Relatable stories

Weave narratives that make your message memorable and impactful.



Questions

Encourage questions and give thoughtful responses to enhance participation.



Live polls and surveys

Gather opinions so the audience feels involved (e.g., Mentimeter, Slido, a show of hands).

Interaction ideas

- ‘How many of you have experienced this?’
- Think–pair–share: one minute with your neighbour
- Predict the result before you reveal it
- Ask for a word cloud: ‘one word for how you feel about presenting’
- Invite one volunteer to try the technique live

Navigating Q&A sessions

Before

- Know your material in advance
- Anticipate common questions
- Rehearse your responses

During - stay composed

- Stay calm
- Actively listen
- Pause and reflect
- Maintain eye contact

Composure in Q&A projects confidence and authority.

The ABC bridge

A **Acknowledge**
'That's an important concern.'

B **Bridge**
'What the data shows is…'

C **Communicate**
Return to your key message.

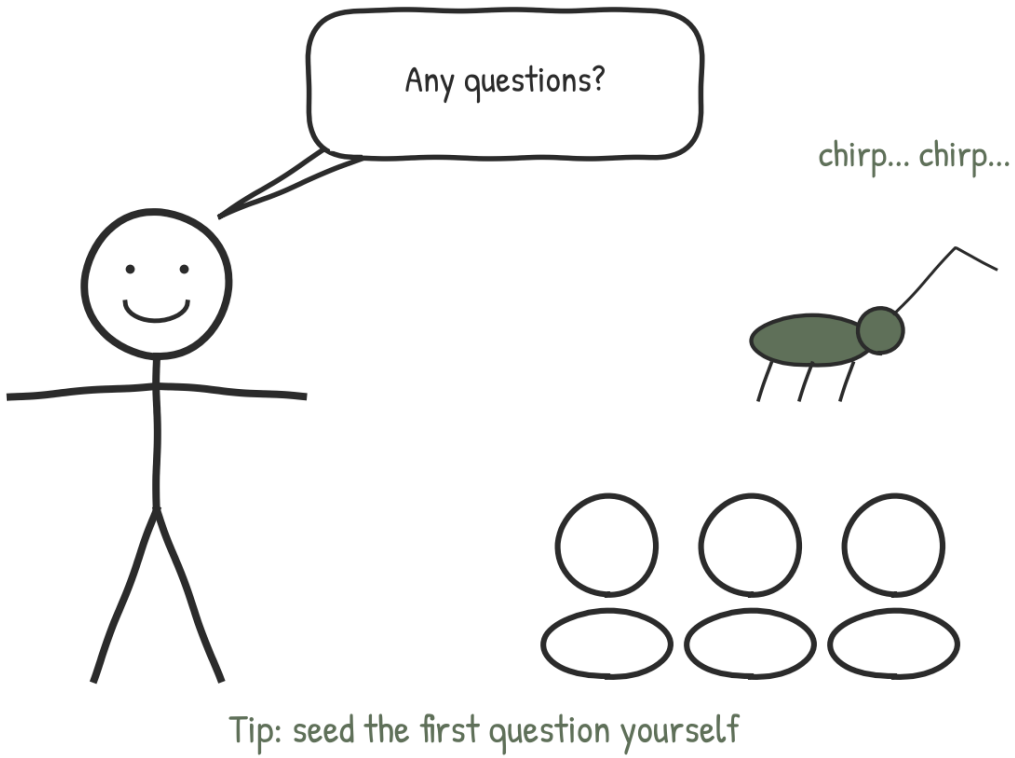
Don't know? Say so: 'I don't know - I'll check and email you by Friday.' Credibility rises.



The Q&A classic: have a polite bridge ready

Repeat each question so the whole room (and any recording) hears it.

When the room goes quiet



- Wait 5-7 seconds. Silence means people are thinking
- Seed it: ‘A question I’m often asked is…’
- Ask ‘What questions do you have?’ instead of ‘Any questions?’
- Give one minute to discuss in pairs, then collect
- Offer an anonymous channel (chat, Slido, cards)

MODULE 08

Visual design

Format: aesthetic and professional design



Format: aesthetic and professional design

Simplicity

Keep slides clean and free of clutter. Use consistent fonts and colours that align with your message.

Font size

Ensure all text is readable from the back of the room (as a rule of thumb, nothing below 24 pt on screen). Avoid overloading slides with text.

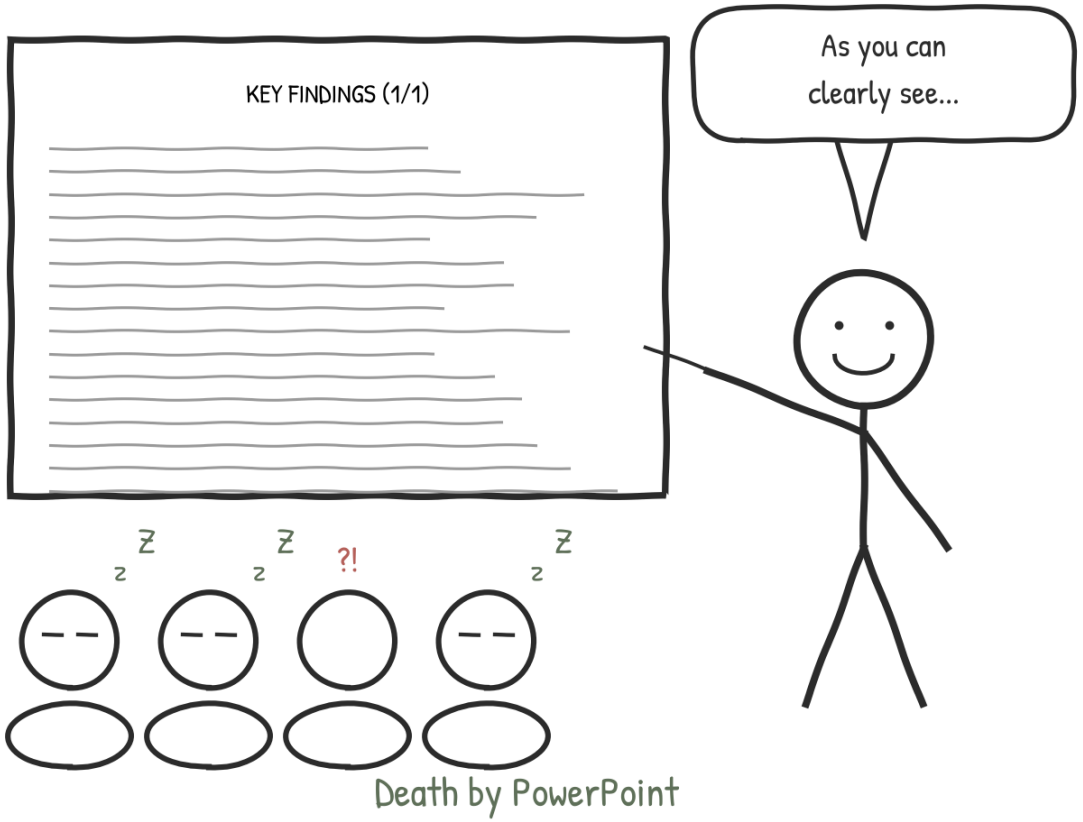
Contrast

Use high contrast between text and background to make information easy to read.

White space

Don’t be afraid of empty space. It keeps slides from feeling overwhelming and focuses attention on key points.

The power of visuals



Infographics

Visual representations of data make information more digestible.

Photos and icons

Support your message with relevant, high-quality, professional visuals.

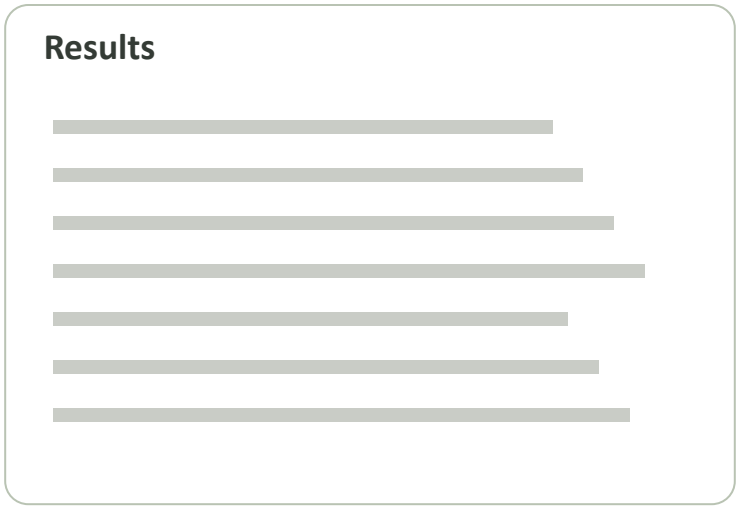
Animations

Use sparingly and purposefully. Too much movement distracts from the message.

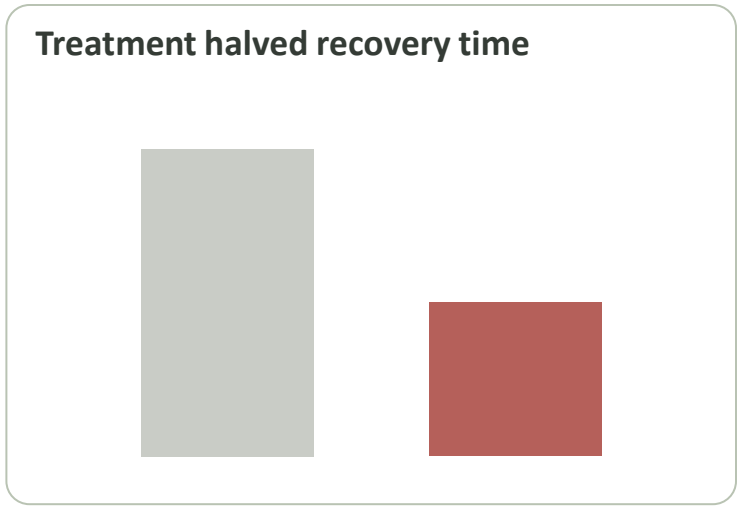
Consistency

Keep colours, fonts and visual styles consistent throughout.

Assertion-evidence slides: a lesson from NASA



Topic title + bullets



Sentence headline + visual evidence

Assertion–evidence (Michael Alley): the headline is a full-sentence claim of no more than two lines; the body is visual evidence - a graph, photo or diagram - not a bullet list.

Illustrative mock-ups

Case: Columbia, 2003

During the mission, a key warning about foam-strike risk sat in a low-level bullet on a dense slide. Edward Tufte analysed the slide, and the Columbia Accident Investigation Board criticised NASA's reliance on briefing slides instead of technical papers.

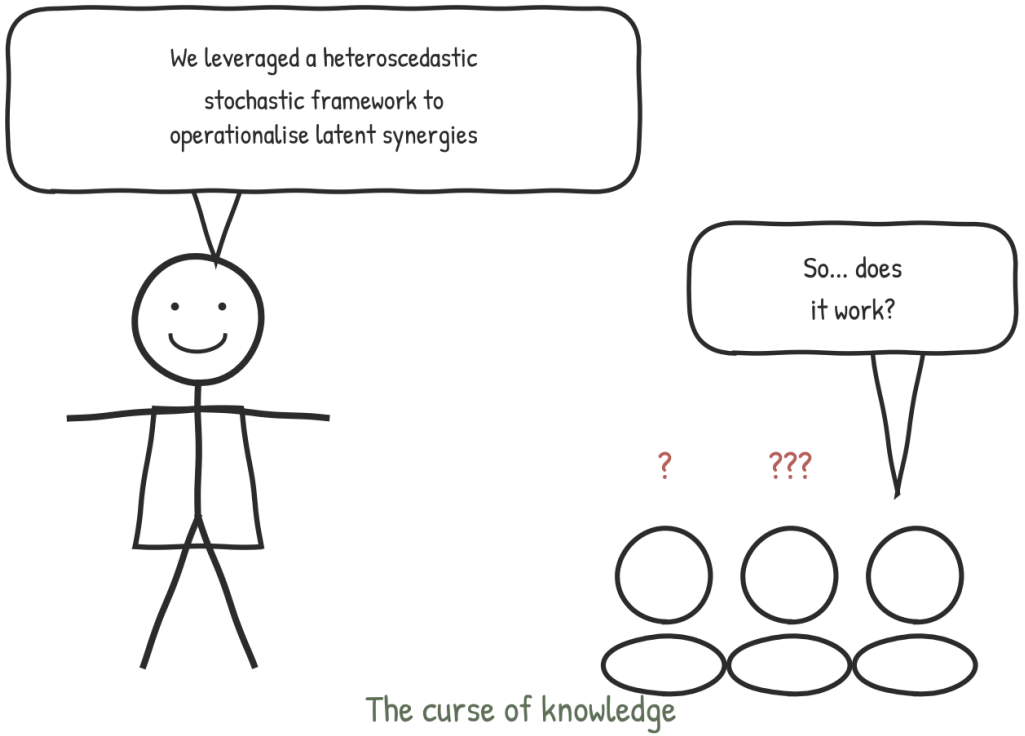
MODULE 09

Communication in applied sciences

Engineering, medicine, IT, economics: making complex ideas clear without dumbing them down



Explaining science and technology to any audience



▷ 3MT competition: watch winning talks

Explain it simply

The ‘Feynman test’: if you can’t explain it to a first-year student, you haven’t understood it well enough yet.

Three Minute Thesis

Researchers present their work in 3 minutes, with one static slide, to non-specialists (University of Queensland, since 2008).

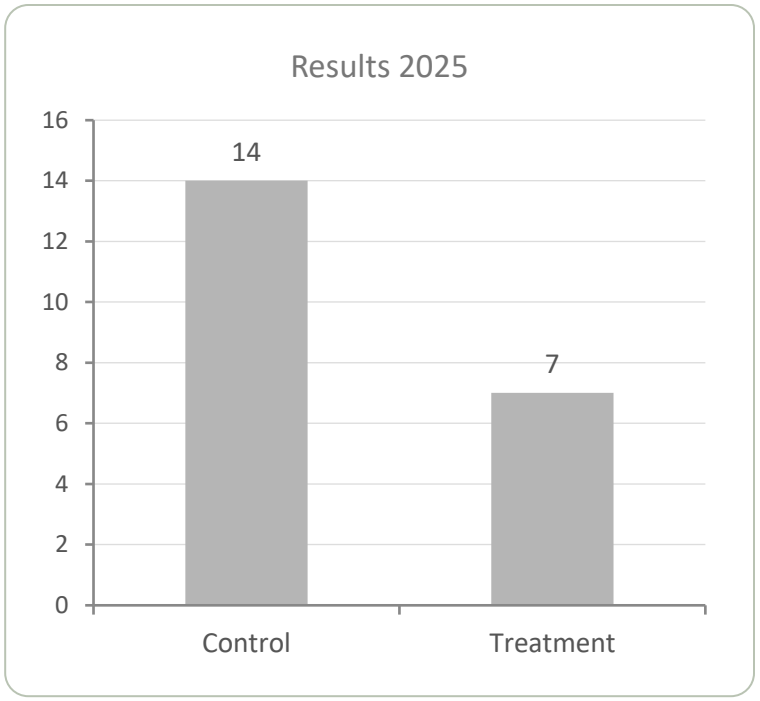
Lead with ‘so what?’

Start with why the result matters, then method and limits - the reverse of a research paper.

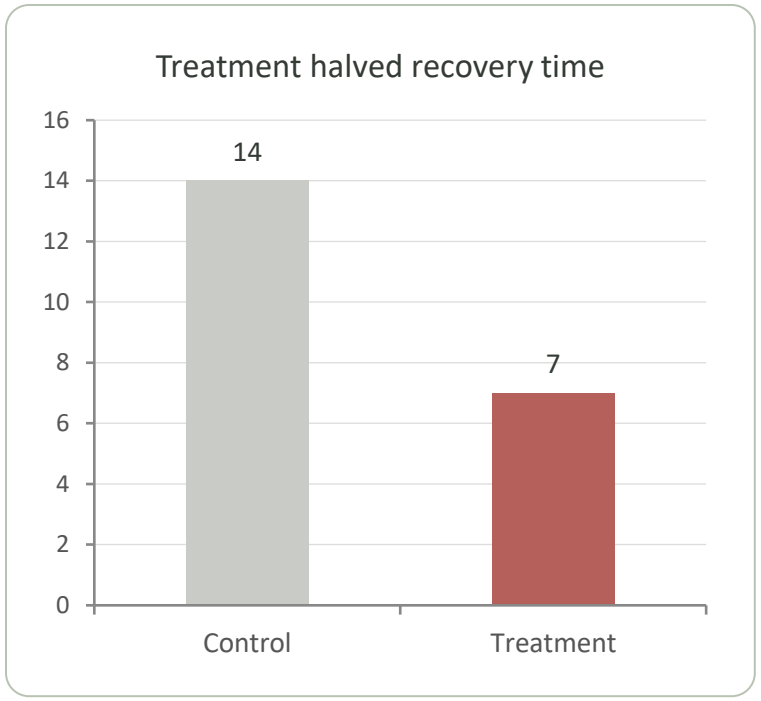
Be honest about uncertainty

Give ranges and limitations. Trust in science depends on it.

Telling stories with data



Before: a topic title, all bars equal



After: the title states the insight, colour points to it

- One message per chart
- Write the insight as the title
- Highlight what matters; grey out the rest
- Remove ‘chartjunk’ (Tufte): 3D, heavy grids, legends you can label directly
- Put numbers on a human scale: ‘1 in 4 patients’, not ‘25.3%’

Illustrative data

▷ **Hans Rosling, ‘The best stats you’ve ever seen’ (TED 2006) — data as live storytelling**

Plain English for technical communication

Instead of…	Say…
utilize	**use**
in order to	**to**
at this point in time	**now**
facilitate	**help**
leverage synergies	**work together**
a significant number of	**62% (give the number)**
it was decided that…	**we decided… (active voice)**

Why it matters in ESP

- Most international audiences listen in their second or third language
- Define every acronym the first time: ‘LLM (large language model)’
- Prefer verbs to nominalisations: ‘we analysed’ beats ‘the analysis was performed’
- Plain does not mean simplistic: keep the precise technical term, then explain it once

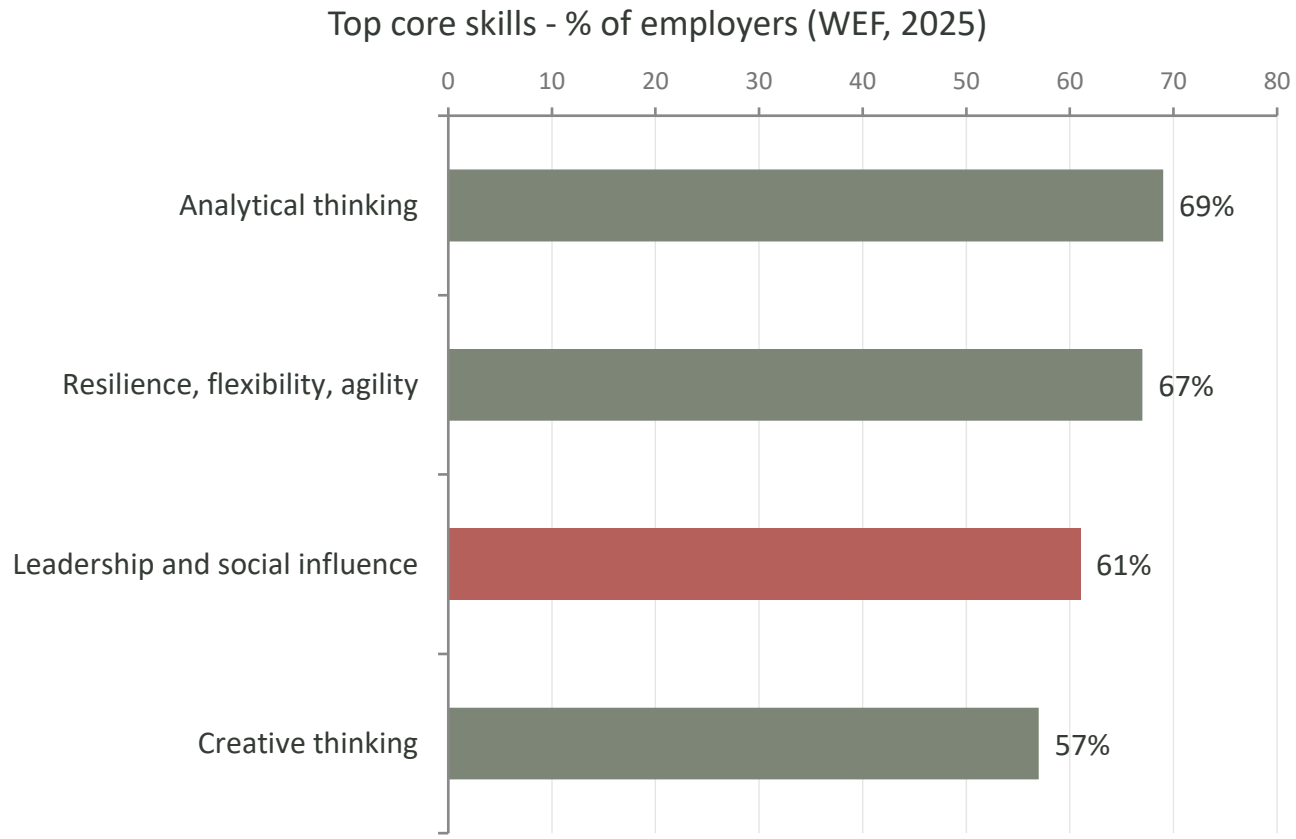
MODULE 10

Communication in today's workplace

What international companies ask for - and the formats you will meet at work



What employers ask for (2025–2026 data)



Source: World Economic Forum, Future of Jobs Report 2025 (survey of 1,000+ employers in 55 economies). 'Empathy and active listening' is also in the top ten.

#1 Communication, teamwork and problem-solving top the skills employers seek on graduates' résumés (NACE, Job Outlook 2026 Spring Update).

Gap Employers rate communication among the most important skills - yet are less impressed with new graduates' communication than with their teamwork.

Proof Employers want examples, not lists: tell a short story of when you used the skill.

Communicating across borders: English as a lingua franca

Use global English

Avoid idioms and sports metaphors: ‘ballpark figure’, ‘touch base’, ‘hit it out of the park’.

Slow down, signpost more

Short sentences, clear transitions: ‘Point two of three…’

Show what you say

Key numbers and terms on screen help listeners in their second language.

Check understanding

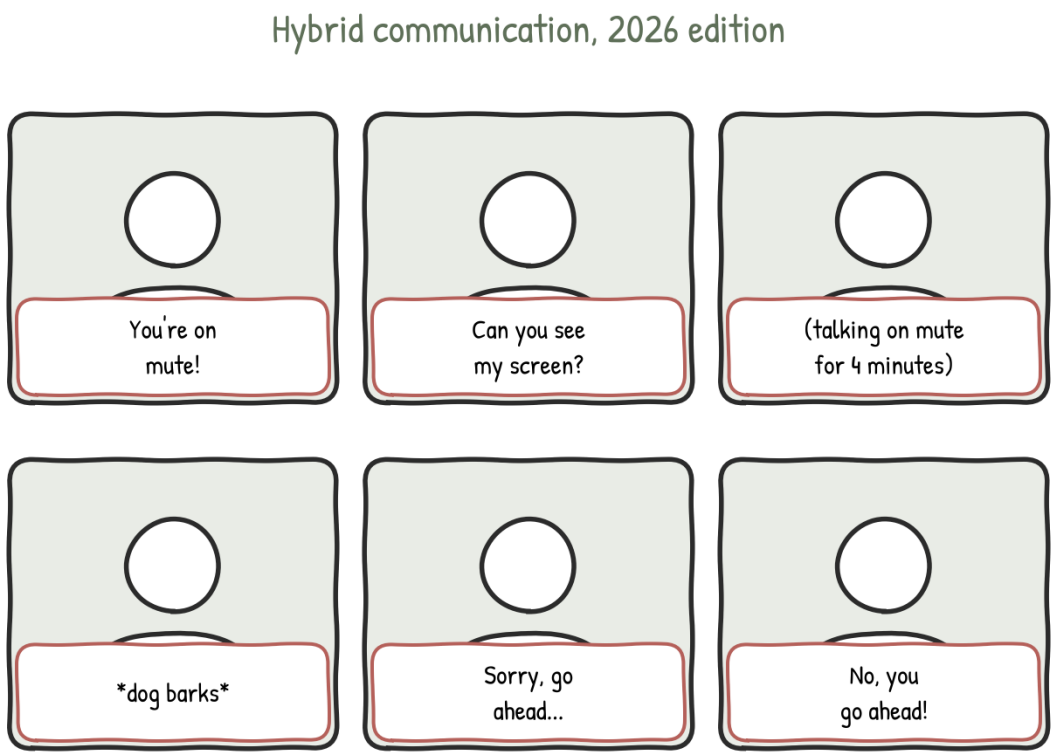
‘What would you add?’ works better than ‘Is that clear?’

High- vs low-context cultures

Some cultures say things explicitly; others rely on context and implication (E. T. Hall). Erin Meyer’s ‘Culture Map’ shows, for example, that Dutch professionals tend to give direct negative feedback, while many Asian cultures prefer indirect feedback.

Treat cultural patterns as starting hypotheses about a group, never as labels for an individual.

Presenting online and in hybrid meetings



- Camera at eye level; look at the lens for key messages
- Light in front of you, not behind
- Sound beats image: a decent microphone matters most
- Interact every few minutes: poll, chat question, call people by name
- Shorter segments; pause before handing over
- Ask a co-host to watch the chat and remote participants
- Hybrid: include the remote people first, not last

AI and the presenter in 2026



Useful for

- Brainstorming structure and examples
- Generating likely audience questions
- Rehearsal feedback on pace and fillers (e.g., Speaker Coach in PowerPoint)
- Live captions and translation



Watch out for

- Invented facts and citations
- Generic, ‘AI-sounding’ slides and phrases
- Losing your own voice and stories
- Confidential data in public tools

The rule

AI can draft. You must own the message: verify every fact, add your experience, and follow your institution’s disclosure rules.

NACE (2026): AI skills are increasingly expected of graduates - yet communication remains the skill that separates candidates.

Formats you will meet at work

Elevator pitch

30–60 seconds: who you are, what you offer, what you ask.

Pecha Kucha

20 slides × 20 seconds each, auto-advancing. Forces rhythm and focus.

3MT / lightning talk

3–5 minutes, one idea, minimal slides.

Narrative memo

Amazon replaced slide decks in senior meetings with six-page memos read at the start.

Async video update

A 2-minute recorded update replaces a 30-minute meeting.

Stand-up / status

Done, next, blocked - in under a minute each.

MODULE 11

Practice and growth

Rehearse, measure, reflect — and keep learning



Final tips and takeaways

1. **Consistent rehearsal**
   Strengthen your familiarity

2. **Refine delivery style**
   Pacing, tone and emphasis

3. **Timing and transitions**
   Aim for seamless, professional delivery

4. **Practice audience**
   Enlist colleagues to listen and give feedback

The growth loop

- Seek feedback
- Reflect on performance
- Explore new techniques
- Set personal goals
- Iterate and adapt

Dynamic delivery: measure your impact

Learn to infuse energy into your delivery to leave a lasting impression.

One of the goals of effective communication is to motivate your audience.

Sample evaluation sheet - replace with your own event data.

Metric	Measurement	Target	Actual
Audience attendance	# of attendees	150	**120**
Engagement duration	Minutes	60	**75**
Q&A interaction	# of questions	10	**15**
Positive feedback	Percentage (%)	90	**95**
Rate of information retention	Percentage (%)	80	**85**

Speaking engagement metrics

Impact factor	Measurement	Target	Achieved
Audience interaction	Percentage (%)	85	**88**
Knowledge retention	Percentage (%)	75	**80**
Post-presentation surveys	Average rating	4.2	**4.5**
Referral rate	Percentage (%)	10	**12**
Collaboration opportunities	# of opportunities	8	**10**

Sample data from the original course deck

How to collect it

- 2-question exit poll
- A short quiz a week later (retention)
- Count questions and follow-up emails
- Ask one trusted colleague for a ‘keep / change’ note

Workshop: practise it

1

60-second introduction

Who you are, what you do, one surprising fact. Peer feedback: one ‘keep’, one ‘change’.

2

Rhetoric remix

Rewrite a dull sentence from your field using a tricolon or anaphora.

3

Pecha Kucha 20×20

Present a hobby or a research idea; slides advance automatically.

4

Hot seat Q&A

Answer three tough questions using the ABC bridge.

5

Empathy role-play

Turn a complaint into Observation–Feeling–Need–Request.

6

Record and review

Film 2 minutes; count fillers, check pace, eye contact and gestures.

Video library

Chris Anderson
TED's secret to great public speaking (2016)

Julian Treasure
How to speak so that people want to listen (2013)

Nancy Duarte
The secret structure of great talks (2011)

Simon Sinek
How great leaders inspire action (2009)

Brené Brown
The power of vulnerability (2010)

Amy Cuddy
Your body language may shape who you are (2012)

Hans Rosling
The best stats you've ever seen (2006)

Steve Jobs
Stanford commencement address (2005)

Will Stephen
How to sound smart in your TEDx talk (2015) — a parody

Martin Luther King Jr.
I Have a Dream (1963) — text and audio

Click a title to open it. The parody (highlighted) is a fun way to discuss what 'sounding smart' without content looks like.

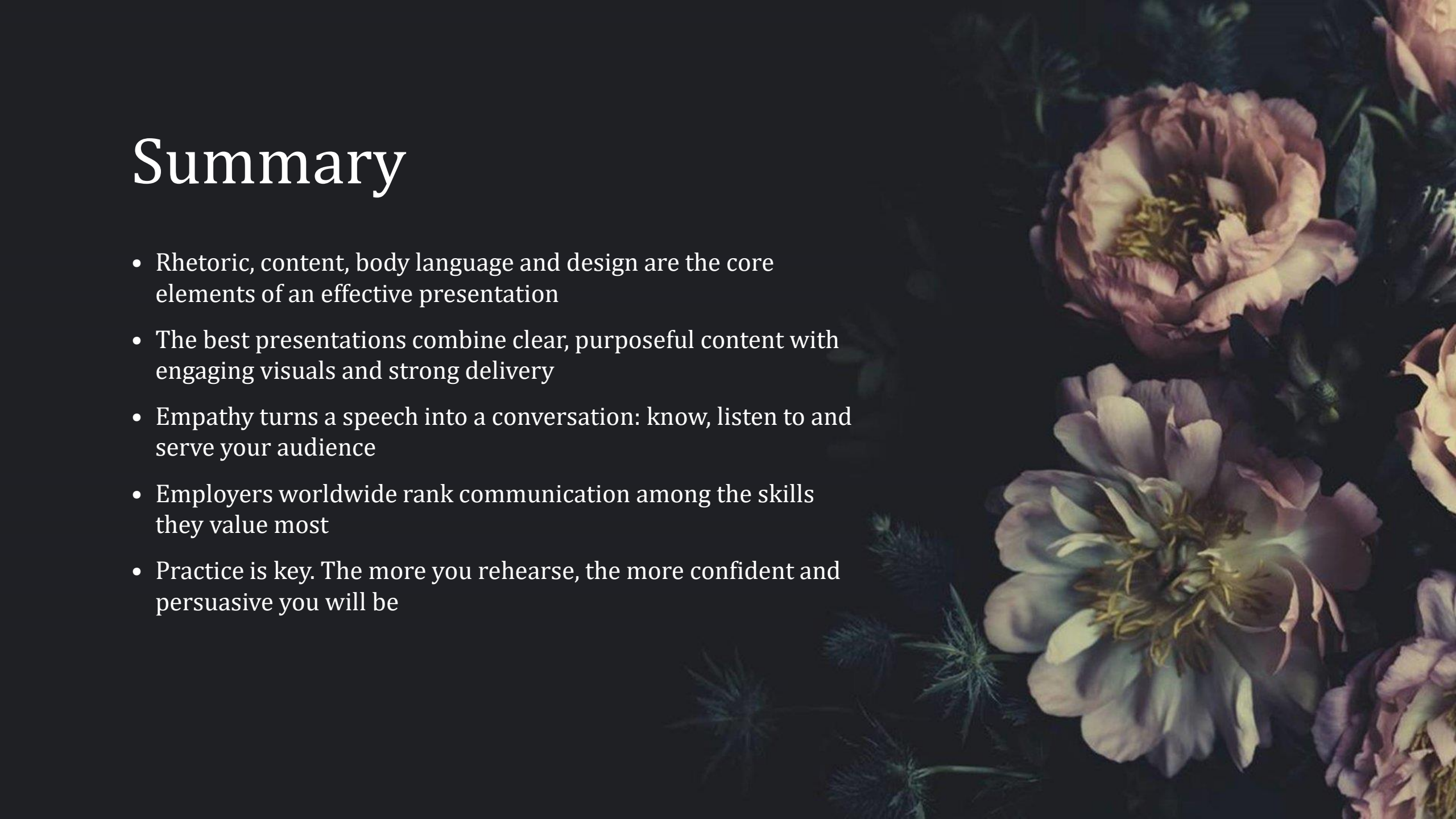
Speaking impact

Your ability to communicate effectively will leave a lasting impact on your audience.

Effective communication involves not only delivering a message but also resonating with the experiences, values and emotions of those listening.

Summary

- Rhetoric, content, body language and design are the core elements of an effective presentation
- The best presentations combine clear, purposeful content with engaging visuals and strong delivery
- Empathy turns a speech into a conversation: know, listen to and serve your audience
- Employers worldwide rank communication among the skills they value most
- Practice is key. The more you rehearse, the more confident and persuasive you will be



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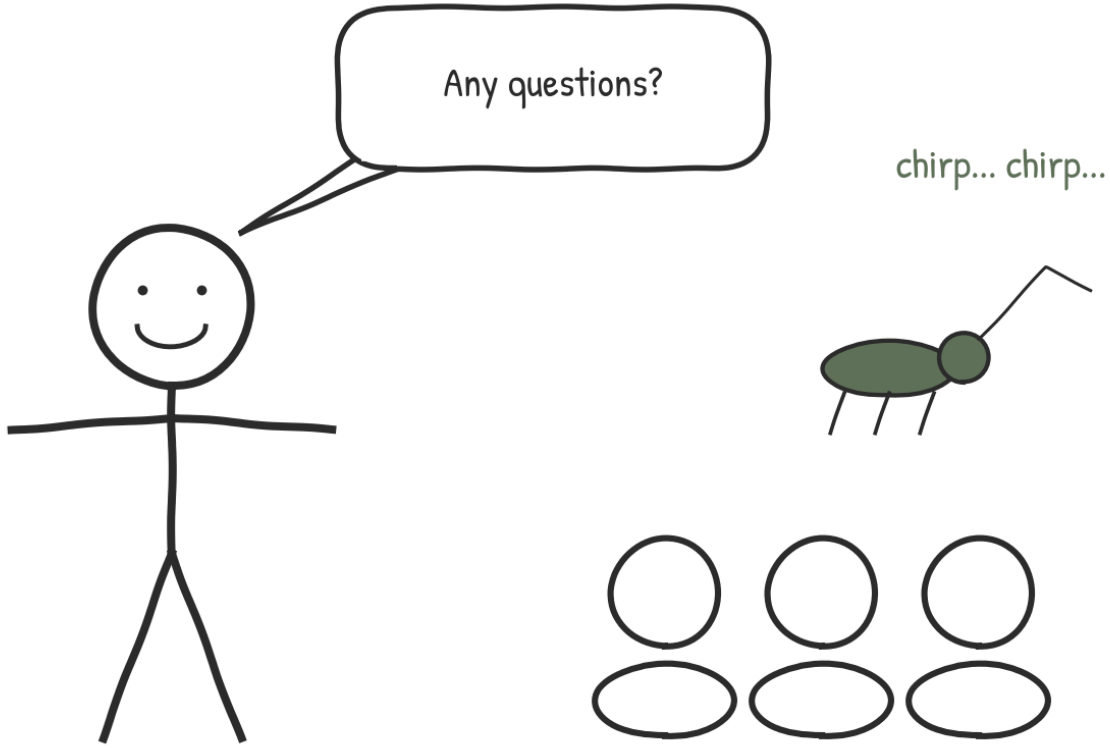
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Thank you! What questions do you have?



Tip: seed the first question yourself